



Review and research

- 1 List the names of people mentioned in the timeline. Go to your library and use a reference book like the *Oxford Classical Dictionary* to find out who they were.
- 2 What is an 'achievement'? Discuss your answer with the rest of your class and build up a group definition that will help you when working through this chapter.
- 3 Create a time chart by dividing your page into three columns. Down one edge mark in the years 356–323BC. Write a heading in each column: Military, Civil, Problems.
 - In the Military column list the battles and sieges Alexander fought.
 - In the Civil column list all the cities he founded.
 - In the Problems column, list all the problems and difficulties Alexander confronted such as conspiracies and mutinies.

Timeline

- 356 BC Alexander born, son of Philip II of Macedonia and Olympias of Epirus.
- 341–340 Made regent of Macedonia while Philip fighting in Thrace. Defeats the Maedi, a Thracian tribe, who had rebelled. Builds a city, Alexandropolis, in the area.
- 340–339 Subdues cities in southern Thrace. Goes with Philip on campaign. Helps to prevent an Illyrian invasion of Macedonia.
- 338 Leads the Companion cavalry at the Battle of Chaeronea.
- 336 Philip assassinated. Alexander becomes Macedonian king. Elected general of the League of Corinth.
- 335 Fights in Thrace and Illyria. The Greeks revolt. Destroys Thebes. Re-established Macedonian control of Greece. Darius III becomes Persian king.
- 334 Alexander crosses the Hellespont. Battle of Granicus. Conquers Lydia. Besieges and captures the cities of Miletus and Halicarnassus.
- 334–333 Conquers Lycia, Pamphylia, Pisidia and Cilicia. Unravels the Gordian knot. Battle of Issus.
- 332 Besieges and captures Tyre. Receives submission of Syria and Judaea. Besieges Gaza. Welcomed as a liberator in Egypt. Becomes pharaoh.
- 331 Founds Alexandria in Egypt. Visits the oracle of Zeus Ammon at Siwah. Receives submission of Cyrene. Battle of Gaugamela (Arbela). Becomes King of Asia.
- 330 Persepolis burnt. Persian cities of Pasargadae and Ecbatana occupied. Allied Greek forces sent home.
- July Bessus kills Darius III and assumes title of Great King. Alexander conquers Hyrcania, Areia and Drangiana. Founds cities of Alexandria Areion (Herat) and Alexandria Prophthasia. Proclaims himself Great King. Adopts Persian clothing. Macedonian resentment and unhappiness starts. Philotas implicated in a conspiracy against Alexander, tried and executed. His father Parmenio murdered as well.
- 329 Conquest of Arachosia. Founds Arachosian Alexandria (Kandahar?). Bessus captured and executed.
- 329–28 Alexandria under Caucasus and other cities founded to stop revolts in the area.
- 328 Conquers Bactria and Sogdiana. Alexandria Eschate, 'the furthest' founded (Khodjend?). Marries Roxane, the daughter of the Sogdian prince. Attempts to introduce Persian court ceremonial procedures, such as *proskynesis* to his court. Macedonian and Greek resentment increases.
- 327–26 Alexander kills Cleitus the Black. Conquers eastern Sogdiana. Conspiracy of the Pages uncovered. Callisthenes, one of the official historians, executed. Winter campaigns in the Kunar, Chitral and Sarat regions. Captures Rock of Aornos.
- 326 Battle of the Hydaspes River. Conquers Punjab. Founds Alexandria Bucephala, named after Alexander's horse Bucephalus.
- 325 Alexander forced to return to Babylon by a 'mutiny' of the Macedonian army at the River Hyphasis. The Malli defeated. Founds several towns on the Lower Indus. Constructs a fleet and journeys down the Indus River. Nearchus sent as admiral along the coast to the Persian Gulf and Babylon. Alexander and Craterus journey through the Gedrosian desert and Carmania to Persepolis. Founds Alexandria Carmania.
- 324 Alexander tries to 'fuse' Macedonians and Persians into a new ruling class. Marriage ceremony at Susa of Macedonian soldiers and Iranian women. Alexander marries a Persian princess. Macedonian troops mutiny at Opis. Persian troops introduced into the army. Veteran Macedonian troops sent home. Death of Hephaestion. Harpalus, the empire's treasurer at Babylon, runs away to Athens after stealing funds. Defeat of the Cossaeans.
- 323 Funeral of Hephaestion (May). Alexander dies. Alexander's empire begins to break up.